

What it means if you...

What each shortlisted link would mean for six ways of working

Prepared 6 November 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas

One person, a year, cover weeks aside. Earlies and lates are counted Monday to Saturday, as Sunday is overtime. Pounds are gross, at the CEA rate of £21.49; the Pay Calculator in the app estimates a payslip. **Bold green** marks the clear best of the three for that person.

...prefer earlies

Fewer, longer earlies on every link, in longer runs. Common Ground's are the shortest on average and the most often finish at 13:45; Even Step's are all times worked today. Neither has one over 8h 30m.

IF YOU...	TODAY	COMMON GROUND	EVEN STEP	SHORT RUN
Earlies a year	88	84	84	84
Average early	7h 59m	**8h 09m**	8h 13m	8h 26m
Earlies over 8h 30m, a year	0	**0**	**0**	20
Earlies finishing at 13:35 or 13:45, a year	26	**12**	10	0
Weeks of earlies, or of lates, in a row	2, up to 3	5, up to 7	5, up to 7	5, up to 7

...prefer lates

More lates on every link, in longer runs, and every closer 30 minutes to an hour shorter. Short Run's are the shortest on average.

Lates a year	88	94	94	94
Average late, closers included	8h 29m	8h 21m	8h 18m	**8h 06m**
Longest closing shift, any day	9h 10m	**8h 10m**	**8h 10m**	8h 40m
Finishing at 23:00 or later, any day, a year	39	42	42	42

...swap earlies for lates, for the overtime

Swapping the shortest earlies brings less overtime than today on every link. Common Ground keeps the most from its 13:45 finishes; Short Run has none of those finishes. Other swaps may still add paid time.

A late against an early, same day, on average	32 min longer	12 min longer	5 min longer	20 min shorter
Each 13:35 or 13:45 early swapped for the day's longest late	+34h 40m	+13h 00m	+10h 50m	none
That overtime, gross, at time and a quarter	about £930	about £350	about £290	none

...work your share of Sundays and no other overtime

About £250 to £350 a year less on every link, gross: two more Saturdays at time and a quarter, but fewer, shorter Sundays.

Sundays a year, at time and a half	21	20	20	20
Sunday hours a year	177	164	167	167
Premium and overtime pay, against today	—	about £350 less	about £250 less	about £250 less

...work no overtime at all

A little better off on every link — about £80 to £90 a year, gross, from two more Saturdays at time and a quarter.

Saturday hours a year, at time and a quarter	213	231	228	230
Premium pay, against today	—	about £90 more	about £80 more	about £90 more

...save your leave for long breaks

Four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday, take 15 days' leave on Even Step and Short Run; Common Ground keeps today's 14, for more single rest days. On average 14 days' leave goes as far as today on every link.

Leave for four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday	14 days	**14 days**	15 days	15 days
Days off in a row from 14 days' leave, at best	30	**30**	28	28
Rest-day breaks of three or four days, a year	about 13	**about 4**	none	none

Whoever you are

What every shortlisted link gives everyone, against today.

Full weekends off a year	10	14	14	14
Most days in a row	7, up to 9	5, up to 7	5, up to 7	5, up to 7
Shortest rest between shifts	12h 30m	**14h 35m**	**14h 35m**	14h 20m
Avoidable fatigue warnings	4, up to 5	0, up to 1	0, up to 1	0, up to 1

How these are worked out. Over 52 weeks, two turns of a 26-week link, so a design's figures are everyone's; today's, on 20 weeks, are averages. An early starts before 11:00, a late at 11:00 or after. A swap is counted on the same day: each early against that day's average late, and each 13:35 or 13:45 early — the only earlies that finish before 14:00 — swapped for that day's longest late. That is the most these particular short-early swaps could make, not a forecast: it assumes a partner for every swap, and the extra time paid at time and a quarter ("Overtime 1.25" on a payslip).

The swap rows are not ranked: which link suits a swapper depends on which swaps they make. Nor are the no-overtime rows: the three are within a few Saturday hours a year. The average late includes the closers; the shortlist sheet's weekday lates leave them out. The Sunday figure is the presentations' own, to £50; the others are to £10. Leave: a working day Monday to Saturday costs a day's leave, a rest day or a Sunday none. "Up to" is the worst place a cover week's duties could fall. Fatigue warnings are reported against the ORR's good-practice list, never as pass or fail.